

**Central Office**

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*ex-officio

Programs**Day Treatment Centers**

Eastwood
Greenview
Hopewell
Phoenix
Prentiss
Willow Creek

Connections**Early Childhood Plus****PEP Assist**

May 21, 2019

Joelle Magyar

Superintendent

Brecksville/Broadview Heights City Schools

6638 Mill Road

Brecksville, OH 44141-1599

Dear Joelle:

Positive Education Program (PEP) would like to extend deep gratitude for your commitment to our community's most vulnerable children. As you well know, the severity of the mental health and behavioral challenges many students face continues to deepen. Our partnership is more crucial than ever.

Enclosed is the annual contract for Special Education Services provided by PEP. This agreement is being sent to both the district superintendent and the district's lead special education administrator. Please sign the agreement and return to:

Bruce Basalla, Treasurer

Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio (ESCNEO)

6393 Oak Tree Blvd, Independence, OH 44131

The last year has been one of significant change for PEP, and we appreciate your patience and understanding as we navigate a challenging IT upgrade and personnel shifts. At this point, we believe we are positioned to deliver programming kids deserve and our district partners expect.

All decision-making at PEP starts with one question: What is in the best interest of kids? The appropriate answer to that question is not always the easiest or most convenient. Certainly, this challenging reality is shared by district partners like you.

Also like you, PEP must manage costs in ways that do not compromise our core work of ensuring that all kids learn and grow. Doing so gives us the opportunity to evaluate, adjust and invest in programming that data and experience tell us children need to reach their full potential.

PEP, however, is uniquely challenged in that the agency is exposed to the economic and workforce challenges of both the mental health and education sectors. The State of Ohio's Behavioral Health Redesign continues to impact our revenues.

To that end, 2019-2020 tuition rates at PEP Day Treatment Centers reflect a modest 2% increase for K-8 students enrolled at Eastwood, Greenview, Hopewell, and Willow Creek and a 3% increase for students grades 9-12 at those same centers. At PEP Phoenix, where we serve students dually diagnosed with cognitive and emotional challenges, there will be a 2% increase for all grades. At PEP Prentiss Autism Center, there will be a 1% increase.

Board and staff leadership at PEP did not come to this decision lightly. We believe this adjustment will allow PEP to recruit and retain qualified special education and mental professionals. It will also allow us to invest in relevant and rigorous academic and social-emotional programming.

Our commitment to improving programming is also reflected in some recent leadership changes:

- A search is underway to fill a new executive role – chief instruction and achievement officer – that will build upon the portfolio of PEP’s retiring chief program officer, Claudia Lann Valore. This individual will be responsible for vision and strategic leadership of all aspects of PEP programming that involve implementation of equitable practices in teaching and learning, school climate and school discipline.
- In addition, we have restructured the leadership team to charge one key individual with oversight of PEP Day Treatment Centers. PEP veteran Aaron Muttillio will assume this newly created role effective July 1.

Helping kids heal is not only our business. It is our passion, which is why PEP Assist consultation and training services have proven to be a cost-effective support for challenging students within the district setting. Our agile consultants and coaches are available for in-classroom support, one-on-one interventions, and whole district or individual classroom consultations, in-service trainings, among other offerings.

Meanwhile, many of our partners have inquired about the fate of PEP Connections, our intensive case management service. We continue to advocate for another year of bridge funding as the state pursues adding this critical support to Medicaid’s billable menu of behavioral health services. Leaders in Columbus appear increasingly open to understanding the impact of childhood trauma, which bodes well for PEP and the vulnerable children and families we serve.

Our work is not easy, but it is necessary. Growth and change are possible. We see this daily.

We are interested in continuing a dialogue. Please feel free to contact Habeebah R. Grimes at 216-361-4400 ext. 123 for more information or to discuss the contract or services.

We look to working together to ensure all kids can learn and grow.

Sincerely,



Robert A. Mengerink, Ed. D.
Superintendent
Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio



Habeebah R. Grimes
Chief Executive Officer
Positive Education Program

Enclosure

c: Gina Symsek

EDUCATIONAL SERVICE CENTER OF NORTHEAST OHIO
AGREEMENT FOR ADMISSION OF PUPILS PURSUANT TO OHIO REVISED CODE SECTION 3313.841

The Board of Education for (**Educating District**) _____ hereby enters into a contract for the admission of pupils to the Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio for educational purposes for the school year of 2019-2020. The above-referenced Board of Education ("the Educating District") hereby agrees to pay to the Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio ("ESCNEO") for each pupil an amount equal to the Program Cost per Enrollment Day as listed below.

In cases where the Educating District is not also the District of Residence, the Educating District acknowledges that it is solely responsible for paying to the ESCNEO the per pupil amount equal to the Program Cost as listed below, and is solely responsible for seeking reimbursement from the District of Residence as authorized by Ohio Revised Code Chapter 3323.

In cases where a pupil who receives services from a program listed below transfers to a different Educating District and continues his/her placement with Positive Education Program (PEP) following the transfer, the Educating District acknowledges that it is solely responsible for paying to the ESCNEO the per pupil amount equal to the program cost as listed below as soon as the Educating District receives evidence that the pupil is present in the district, is eligible for services, and a copy of the most recent applicable IEP as required by 34 CFR §300.323 and Ohio Administrative Code §3301-51-07(K)(5).

The Educating District also acknowledges that it is responsible for transporting each pupil, and for seeking reimbursement for transportation costs from the District of Residence as authorized by Ohio Revised Code Chapter 3323.

Positive Education Program Service:	Rate per Enrollment Day
Eastwood, Greenview, Hopewell & Willow Creek DTC - Grades K to 8 (Maximum 185 billable days)	\$248
Eastwood, Greenview, Hopewell & Willow Creek DTC - Grades 9 to 12 (Maximum 185 billable days)	\$257
Phoenix DTC – All Grades (Maximum 185 billable days)	\$318
Prentiss Autism Center – All Grades (Maximum 194 billable enrollment days)	\$433
Home Instruction	\$248

Billing for services rendered will be on a monthly basis.

(Signature) Superintendent of Educating District

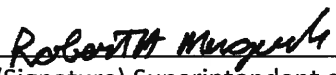
Date

(Signature) Treasurer of Educating District

Date

Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio (ESCNEO)

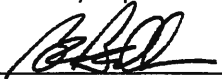
We hereby agree to admit students from the aforementioned school district pursuant to the above-referenced provisions for the school year 2019-2020.



(Signature) Superintendent of ESC of Northeast Ohio

May 20, 2019

Date



(Signature) Treasurer of ESC of Northeast Ohio

May 20, 2019

Date

Please return a signed copy of the agreement to:

Bruce Basalla, Treasurer • ESC of Northeast Ohio • 6393 Oak Tree Boulevard • Independence, OH 44131